



Counseling Manual Draft Comparison

Claxton draft compared with the current 2026 working draft

This document compares the draft titled DRAFT St. Louis Public Schools Comprehensive Counseling Manual -Claxton with the current SLPS School Counseling Handbook 2026 Draft. It is a comparison document only. It does not revise either draft.

Generated June 28, 2026 from local PDF text extraction. Page counts and word counts are extraction-based and may differ slightly from visual page review. SLPS branding is used for internal district working-draft review.

Bottom line: based on extracted text, the current draft appears to be a substantially redesigned operating handbook, while the Claxton draft is a comparison source that embeds standards, job descriptions, ethics text, and resource material directly in the manual body.

95	109	13,879	27,148
Claxton draft pages	Current draft pages	Claxton extracted words	Current extracted words

Quick Read

The drafts are not two versions of the same layout. Claxton is closer to a compilation manual that embeds source standards, including current ASCA Ethical Standards and Missouri Learning Standards tables, job descriptions, ethics text, and a provider directory directly in the manual body. The current draft is a redesigned operating handbook. It retains the core program concepts but expands implementation controls, procedures, role boundaries, evaluation routines, and appendices.

The key review decision is whether Claxton artifacts should remain in the handbook body, move to a source/reference file, or be replaced by current controlled district sources.

At a Glance

Measure	Claxton draft	Current draft	Meaning
Pages	95	109	Current draft is approximately 14 pages longer based on extraction.
Extracted words	13,879	27,148	Current draft has about twice the extracted word count; this reflects text volume, not necessarily twice the substantive content.
Primary organization	Legacy Missouri comprehensive guidance/CSCP manual sections	Updated CSCP operating handbook sections	Current draft is organized around implementation, procedures, and forms.
Main format signal	Manual with source material inserted	District operating handbook with appendices	Current draft separates reference/source material from operating content.

Review Flags

Item	Difference	Recommended decision
Provider directory	Claxton includes names and phone numbers. Current draft does not.	Recommended to keep outside the handbook in a controlled, updateable resource list because provider data changes.
Full ASCA ethics text	Claxton reproduces the standard. Current draft references and operationalizes ethics.	Recommended to cite/link or include in source reference rather than reproduce full external standards in the manual body.
Legacy job descriptions	Claxton reproduces job descriptions. Current draft summarizes role expectations.	HR should confirm whether current official job descriptions should be linked, quoted, or kept outside the handbook.
Historical acknowledgements	Claxton includes committee and acknowledgement material. Current draft omits it.	Decide whether this belongs in front matter, archive notes, or the source/reference document.
Responsive service time allocation	Claxton shows 0 percent responsive service in its State Distribution table, but Claxton also describes responsive services as a program component. Current draft treats responsive services as a core time allocation.	Review before final approval because the Claxton table may be an error or extraction issue.
ReThink Ed reference	Claxton names ReThink Ed/Rethink ED as the SEL platform. Current draft does not name a specific platform.	Include only if the district confirms the platform is current and should be in a controlled handbook.
Board policy section	Claxton contents list board policy but extracted pages do not provide a substantive policy section. The contents also show duplicated Section V numbering and a V111 typo.	Current draft is stronger, but should be reviewed by district policy/legal leadership.
Claxton source quality issues	The extracted Claxton text appears to duplicate ASCA A.10 Marginalized Populations and contains table-of-contents numbering errors.	Treat these as reasons to use Claxton as a source for review, not as a formatting model.
Core beliefs equity language	Claxton includes the phrase The African American Achievement Gap can be eliminated. Current draft has equity content but not this exact phrase.	Decide whether to preserve, update, or archive the exact language.
Vision and mission scope	Claxton uses district-wide vision and mission language. Current draft uses counseling-program-specific vision and mission language.	Decide whether the current handbook also needs district-wide vision and mission front matter.

Top Leadership Decisions

1. Where should the provider directory live: handbook body, source/reference document, or a controlled live resource list?
2. Should the full ASCA Ethical Standards be reproduced, linked, cited, or summarized?
3. Which responsive service time allocation should be used after resolving Claxton's 0 percent table conflict?
4. Should legacy job descriptions and HR-controlled fields be quoted in the handbook or kept as HR-controlled references?
5. Should Claxton's exact equity language and district-wide vision/mission language be preserved in the current draft?

Substantive Program Differences

#	Difference	Evidence	Review implication
1	Current draft is an operating handbook, not a revised copy of the Claxton draft.	The current draft adds planning artifacts, procedures, calendars, role boundaries, and implementation tools. The Claxton draft reads more like a compilation of standards, job descriptions, ethics text, and resource lists.	Use the current draft as the working manual, but verify any district-required legacy language before deletion.
2	Claxton includes source/reference material inside the manual.	The full ASCA ethical standards and a mental health provider directory are embedded in Claxton. The current draft mostly summarizes or references those areas and keeps live or changing resources out of the manual body.	Decide whether SLPS wants these items in a source/reference document instead of the handbook.
3	Current draft standardizes mixed terminology.	Claxton uses mixed language: older labels such as guidance program and MCCP appear alongside current Missouri Learning Standards language such as intrapersonal/interpersonal development and ICAP. Current draft standardizes on school counseling program, Missouri CSCP, academic/career/intrapersonal/interpersonal development, and current program management language.	Keep the current terminology unless SLPS leadership requests legacy labels for continuity.
4	Current draft has stronger implementation controls.	Claxton names implementation steps, but current draft provides annual administrative agreements, advisory council routines, use-of-time analysis, data review, annual results reporting, and manual maintenance.	Preserve these controls in the final handbook.
5	The drafts differ sharply on responsive service time allocation.	Claxton's State Distribution for Counseling Services table shows 0 percent responsive service at elementary, middle, and high school levels, which conflicts with Claxton's own program-component description. Current draft treats responsive services as a core program component and includes planning ranges that allocate substantial counselor time to responsive services.	District leadership should confirm the intended allocation before relying on either draft's percentages.
6	Current draft adds extensive operational appendices.	Current draft includes grade-level scope sequences, planning templates, transcript/ICAP tools, referral forms, safety and behavior forms, PROBE, and annual results templates. Claxton does not include operational counseling forms in the extracted PDF.	Keep these appendices, but confirm live district forms before final approval.
7	Current draft adds role-boundary collaboration guidance.	Current draft has explicit counselor collaboration sections for social workers, psychologists, nurses, administrators, and teachers. Claxton includes general collaboration language but no equivalent role-boundary guidance.	Preserve the role-boundary sections because they reduce implementation ambiguity.
8	Current draft adds explicit equity and access content.	Current draft includes culturally responsive practice, underserved student populations, students with disabilities, English learners, and students experiencing homelessness, foster care, or high mobility. Claxton does not present these as dedicated operating sections in the extracted text.	Keep these sections and route them for district equity, legal, and student-support review.
9	Vision and mission differ in scope.	Claxton carries district-level vision and mission language, including the district of choice framing. Current draft uses counseling-program-specific vision and mission language.	Decide whether district-wide vision/mission language should also appear in the current handbook front matter.
10	Claxton includes a specific equity commitment not carried forward verbatim.	Claxton states that the African American Achievement Gap can be eliminated. Current draft includes equity and underserved-student sections but does not use that exact phrase in the extracted text.	Confirm whether this exact commitment should be preserved, revised, or placed in a historical/source note.

#	Difference	Evidence	Review implication
11	Claxton names specific counselor responsibilities that should be checked against current procedures.	Claxton's essential responsibilities list includes suicide risk and harm-to-others assessments, IEP and 504 meeting participation, special education testing referrals, and 504 coordination with the school nurse.	Ask counseling leadership, HR, legal, and student support teams which responsibilities should be stated directly in the handbook.

Structural And Editorial Differences

#	Difference	Evidence	Review implication
1	Claxton table of contents has structural errors.	The contents repeat Section V and render Section VIII as V111. See also the Claxton source quality review flag.	Correct if Claxton remains in circulation. Do not carry these numbering errors into the current handbook.
2	Claxton appears to duplicate an ASCA ethics subsection.	The extracted text shows A.10 Marginalized Populations twice. See also the Claxton source quality review flag.	Treat as a source quality issue and avoid reproducing the duplicate in the handbook.
3	Claxton names a specific SEL platform.	Claxton references ReThink Ed/Rethink ED. Current draft does not name a platform.	Confirm whether any platform reference is current before including it in a handbook.
4	Current draft includes a transition bridge for old standards codes.	Current draft adds Legacy Standards Continuity and Current Missouri Alignment to connect PS/AD/CD codes to current content areas.	Keep this bridge if reviewers need continuity from prior manuals.

Claxton Material Not Reproduced Verbatim

- Acknowledgement from Dr. Henning and committee member list.
- Board assurances as a distinct historical subsection.
- Large inserted K-12 Missouri Learning Standards School Counseling tables under the old section title.
- Full elementary and secondary job descriptions with legacy payroll/personnel details.
- Full ASCA Ethical Standards text reproduced in the manual.
- Mental health and adolescent substance abuse provider directory with named agencies and phone numbers.
- ReThink Ed/Rethink ED named as the SEL platform.
- Detailed facilities list, including counselor offices, group rooms, career centers, waiting areas, conference rooms, resource libraries, technology, record storage, and presentation spaces.
- State Distribution for Counseling Services table showing 0 percent responsive service in the extracted text.
- District-level vision and mission language, including district of choice framing.
- Specific equity phrase: The African American Achievement Gap can be eliminated.
- Essential responsibilities list with suicide risk, 504, IEP, and special education testing references.
- Blank or minimally populated end pages after the provider directory in the extracted PDF.

Current Draft Additions Or Expansions

- Purpose and use page that explains how the handbook should function as an operating manual.
- Explicit Missouri CSCP alignment section with framework elements and SLPS implementation use.
- Grade-by-grade implementation emphasis and detailed scope-and-sequence appendices.
- Annual administrative agreement, advisory council, program calendar, needs assessment, use-of-time analysis, data review, and annual results report.
- Appropriate and inappropriate duty guidance, fair-share duties, and full implementation duty protection.
- Procedures for referral, crisis and safety response, mandated reporting, schedule and credit review,

transfer intake, family engagement, community partnerships, records, and controlled procedure references.

- Collaboration guidance for counselors working with social workers, school psychologists, nurses, administrators, and teachers.
- Dedicated culturally responsive practice and underserved student population sections.
- Dedicated sections for students with disabilities, English learners, and students experiencing homelessness, foster care, or high mobility.
- Legacy standards continuity crosswalk mapping PS/AD/CD codes to current Missouri content areas.

- Month-by-month program calendar guidance from July through June.
- ICAP and postsecondary planning milestones table.
- Career platform completion standards and grade-level task matrix.
- Classroom guidance visit standards matrix.
- Manual maintenance expectations, board policy source requirements, and annual policy calendar.
- Operational forms for ICAP, transcript review, senior exit, PROBE, referrals, SST, functional behavior assessment, behavior intervention, individual safety planning, and annual results reporting.

Section Crosswalk

Claxton area	Claxton treatment	Current draft treatment	Status
Table of contents	Claxton pp. 3-4. Brief eight-section outline, duplicated Section V numbering, and Section VIII shown as V111.	Current pp. 2-3. Updated ten-section contents with foundation, framework, program delivery, roles, procedures, maintenance, and appendices.	Reorganized
Section I Introduction	Claxton pp. 4-9. Overview, acknowledgement, committee members, beliefs, board assurances, implementation steps, and counseling program description.	Current pp. 3-5. Foundations section retains purpose, beliefs, vision, mission, program assurances, adoption, goals, outcomes, and rationale.	Partly retained
Section II Content standards and grade-level expectations	Claxton pp. 10-29. Large K-12 Missouri Learning Standards tables for academic, career, and intrapersonal/interpersonal development.	Current pp. 6-17 and 42-84. Reframed into current Missouri CSCP alignment, grade-level implementation, scope-and-sequence matrices, and detailed grade appendices.	Updated
Section III Structural foundation	Claxton pp. 29-32. Vision/mission, staffing patterns, and a more granular facilities list.	Current pp. 8-9 and 26-34. Expanded into structural foundation, program resources, staffing/access, facilities, budget/materials, policy resources, and advisory operations.	Expanded
Section IV Program components	Claxton pp. 32-43. School counseling curriculum, individual student planning, responsive services, system support, ReThink Ed reference, and time-distribution table.	Current pp. 10-11 and 18-25. Same four components are retained and operationalized with procedures, documentation practices, calendars, and forms.	Retained plus expanded
Section V Job descriptions	Claxton pp. 44-50. Full elementary and secondary job descriptions, including payroll type, job numbers, union eligibility, shift length, reports-to field, and ADA disclaimer.	Current pp. 26-28 and 55-60. Job descriptions are summarized and paired with role clarity, appropriate/inappropriate duties, staffing access, and evaluation criteria.	Condensed

Claxton area	Claxton treatment	Current draft treatment	Status
Performance based evaluation	Claxton pp. 51-52. Heading present with no extracted body content.	Current pp. 18-20 and 58-60. Dedicated program management and evaluation content, including use-of-time analysis, data review, annual results report, PROBE/IIR, and evaluation criteria.	Expanded
Section VII Ethical standards	Claxton pp. 53-83. Full ASCA Ethical Standards text is inserted across many pages and appears to include a repeated A.10 Marginalized Populations block.	Current pp. 27-28 and a later reference sheet. Ethics are treated as operational guidance, with the full external standard not reproduced in the handbook.	Referenced, not reproduced
School board policy	Claxton contents list a school board policy section, but the extracted end pages do not provide a substantive policy section.	Current pp. 67-69. Adds board policy article reference, annual policy calendar, source requirements, and regulation integration guidance.	Expanded
Mental health provider directory	Claxton pp. 84-89. Includes several pages of named local providers and contact information.	Current pp. 38-39. Does not reproduce the directory. It uses referral criteria, external services procedures, and controlled procedure references instead.	Removed from handbook

Content Presence Check

This check uses targeted text searches against the extracted PDFs. It is intended as a quick flag list, not a legal citation audit.

Legend: green means the exact phrase or topic was found in extracted text. Red means it was not found in extraction, not that the concept is impossible elsewhere in the original PDF.

Topic or phrase	Claxton draft	Current draft
Acknowledgement from Dr. Henning	Present	Not found in extraction
Committee members	Present	Not found in extraction
Board assurances	Present	Not found in extraction
Content Standards and Grade Level Expectations label	Present	Not found in extraction
Missouri Learning Standards School Counseling label	Present	Not found in extraction
Staffing patterns label	Present	Not found in extraction
Exact ASCA Ethical Standards title phrase	Present	Not found in extraction
ASCA ethical standards reference	Present	Present
Mental Health Service Providers directory	Present	Not found in extraction
Named provider: Annie's Hope	Present	Not found in extraction
ReThink Ed / Rethink ED platform reference	Present	Not found in extraction
African American Achievement Gap phrase	Present	Not found in extraction
District of choice vision phrase	Present	Not found in extraction

Topic or phrase	Claxton draft	Current draft
Essential responsibilities list	Present	Not found in extraction
Suicide risk assessment responsibility	Present	Present
Annual administrative agreement	Not found in extraction	Present
Use-of-time analysis	Not found in extraction	Present
Annual results report	Not found in extraction	Present
Fair-share duties	Not found in extraction	Present
Manual maintenance	Not found in extraction	Present
Career resource and CTE partnership ecosystem	Not found in extraction	Present
Legacy standards continuity crosswalk	Not found in extraction	Present
Culturally responsive practice section	Not found in extraction	Present
Students with disabilities phrase	Present	Present
English learners section	Not found in extraction	Present
Dedicated students with disabilities operating section	Not found in extraction	Present

Recommended Use

Use this comparison as a review map. The current draft appears broader and more operational. Claxton is useful for historical continuity and for checking whether older artifacts need preservation. The next review should decide which Claxton artifacts belong in the handbook itself and which belong in a source/reference companion file.